

Tai Motion

TAI CHI · GUIDE SERIES

Weekly Gentle Nutrition

Seven simple, senior-friendly eating habits to feel steady, strong and well — no counting, no strict rules, just gentle everyday choices.

Simple habits · No dieting · No calorie counting

Welcome to your Nutrition guide

Eating well later in life isn't about strict diets or giving up the foods you love. It's about a handful of gentle habits that keep your energy steady, your body strong, and your meals enjoyable.

This guide shares seven small, doable habits. You don't need to change everything at once — pick one that feels easy, let it settle, then add another. Little by little, they add up to a way of eating that feels natural and good.

There's no calorie counting here and nothing is forbidden. The aim is simply to nourish your body kindly, one comfortable choice at a time.

A quick note before you begin. This is general wellness guidance, not a medical or personalised diet plan. If you have a health condition, take medication (some interact with certain foods), or have specific dietary needs, please check with your doctor or a dietitian before making changes.

How to use this guide

Start with one habit. Choose the one that feels easiest and practise it for a week before adding the next.

Progress, not perfection. A habit followed most days is a wonderful result. An off day changes nothing — simply carry on the next.

Make it yours. Adapt every suggestion to the foods, budget and tastes you enjoy. The best habits are the ones you'll actually keep.

Start With a Steady Breakfast

Good for even energy and fewer cravings later in the day.



1. Have something within an hour or so of waking, even if it's small.
2. Pair a protein (eggs, yogurt, nut butter) with a fibre-rich food (oats, fruit, whole-grain toast).
3. Go easy on sugary cereals and pastries, which can leave you hungry again soon after.

Try this: Oats with berries and a spoon of nuts — protein + fibre in one bowl.

A steady breakfast sets the tone for calmer, more even energy all morning.

Fill Half Your Plate With Vegetables

Good for fibre, vitamins and easy, comfortable digestion.



1. At lunch and dinner, aim to make about half your plate vegetables.
2. Fill the rest with a portion of protein and some whole grains.
3. Mix colours through the week — greens, orange, red and purple each bring something different.

Try this: Add one extra vegetable to a meal you already enjoy.

No need to count anything — “half a plate of colour” is all you have to remember.

Include Protein at Every Meal

Good for keeping your muscles and strength as the years go by.



1. Include a palm-sized portion of protein at each meal — eggs, fish, chicken, beans, lentils, tofu or dairy.
2. Spread it across the day rather than saving it all for dinner.
3. Beans and lentils are gentle, affordable, and easy on the budget.

Try this: Add beans to a soup or a boiled egg to your breakfast.

Protein helps you stay steady on your feet and hold on to strength as you age.

Sip Water Through the Day

Good for energy, digestion and clearer thinking.



1. Keep a glass or bottle of water where you'll see it and sip often.
2. Herbal teas, milk and water-rich foods like soup and fruit all help too.
3. Thirst fades with age, so drink on a gentle routine rather than waiting to feel thirsty.

Try this: A glass of water with each meal, plus one mid-morning and mid-afternoon.

Even mild dehydration can feel like tiredness — a sip is often all you need.

Choose Whole Grains

Good for steady energy and a happy heart.



1. Where you can, pick whole-grain versions of bread, rice, oats and pasta.
2. They release energy slowly, so you stay fuller and steadier for longer.
3. Make the swap gradually — even half-and-half is a lovely start.

Try this: Swap white toast for seeded whole-grain, or white rice for brown.

Whole grains bring extra fibre that's kind to your heart and digestion.

Keep Smart Snacks Within Reach

Good for steady blood sugar and energy between meals.



1. Have a few easy, wholesome snacks ready so you're not caught hungry.
2. Good picks: yogurt and fruit, a handful of nuts, cheese and crackers, or veg sticks.
3. Pair something with a little protein to stay satisfied for longer.

Try this: Yogurt with berries and a few almonds when the afternoon dips.

A smart snack keeps your energy even and takes the edge off before meals.

Eat Slowly and Enjoy It

Good for better digestion and knowing when you're comfortably full.



1. Sit down for meals when you can, away from the television or phone.
2. Take your time and chew well — your body needs a few minutes to feel full.
3. Notice the colours, smells and flavours; eating is meant to be a pleasure.

Try this: Put your fork down between bites and enjoy a slower pace.

Eating calmly helps digestion and makes it easier to stop when you're satisfied.

A gentle day on a plate

Here's how the seven habits can come together in one easy, unhurried day. It's an example, not a rule — swap in the foods you love.

Breakfast — Porridge oats with berries, a spoon of walnuts, and a cup of tea or water.

Mid-morning — A piece of fruit and a small handful of nuts.

Lunch — Half a plate of colourful vegetables or salad, a portion of protein (eggs, beans or chicken), and some whole-grain bread or rice.

Afternoon — Yogurt with a little fruit, and a glass of water.

Dinner — Baked fish or a lentil dish, plenty of vegetables, and a small serving of whole grains.

Through the day — Water and herbal tea, sipped little and often.

Remember: aim for half a plate of colour, a palm of protein, and a sip of water with every meal. Get those three most days and you're doing beautifully.

Easy swaps that add up

Small changes, made gently over time, make a real difference.

Instead of...	Try...
White toast	Seeded whole-grain toast
Sugary cereal	Porridge with fruit
Biscuits with tea	A few nuts or some fruit
White rice or pasta	Brown rice or whole-grain pasta

A fizzy drink

Water with a slice of lemon

Crisps

Veg sticks with hummus

When to check with your doctor. Please speak with a healthcare professional before big diet changes if you have diabetes, kidney disease, take blood thinners or other medication, have swallowing difficulties, or have lost your appetite or weight without meaning to.

This guide is part of the Tai Motion Tai Chi Guide Series. It offers general wellness suggestions only and is not medical or dietary advice. It is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any condition. Always talk to a qualified healthcare professional before changing your diet, especially if you have a health condition or take medication. © Tai Motion.